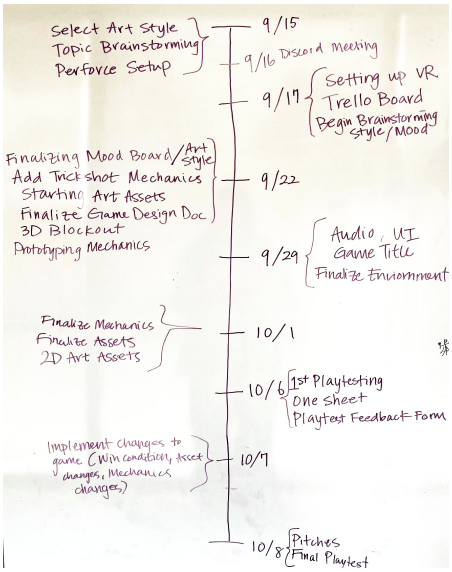
Xiaoxuan Han

Dev Diary

Rapid Prototype 2 - Team 12 - Recycool

Timeline



At the beginning of the project, we began by discussing our art style, brainstorming the game concept, and setting up our workflow. At the first meeting, we quickly agreed on our art style (street art) and came up with several topics and ideas, which we later voted on. After class, we held an additional Discord meeting to change our direction because of feasibility concerns. Despite this change, everyone was on the same page, and we were able to move forward together.

As the project progressed, we moved on to creating assets, developing the mechanics, and constructing the game environment. One important milestone was our first playtest on October 6. It gave us an opportunity to evaluate how the game worked and identify areas that needed improvement. Afterward, we focused on implementing changes to the mechanics and assets before the final playtest and pitch.

Contributions





My work mainly involved modeling, texturing, rigging trash items, and creating some VFX. I created several assets, including a rigged banana, a molded pizza slice, tree branches, and eggshells. This required me to work through the entire asset pipeline, from modeling and rigging in Maya to texturing in Substance 3D Painter and exporting and importing assets into Unreal Engine. Although troubleshooting issues at each stage could be frustrating, it was also an important part of my learning process to practice each intricate step in between.

One problem I encountered was that my initial eggshell model was too detailed. Although I liked the original look very much, when combined with our outline shader, its many fragmented vertices and faces created visual problems, so I had to simplify the model. And a similar

problem happened again for the banana rigging. The initial rig I made was too complex to work well with the physics system in game, so I had to simplify it again.

These experiences reminded me that making game assets is not just about adding detail or achieving realism; they also need to fit our overall art style and perform well in the game. In future projects, I would definitely keep in mind more about the art direction, technical limitations, and optimization requirements during the production process.

Communication

Most of our communication happened through Discord, including online meetings and separate channels for different discussions. We also communicated in person during class and while working in the lab. Everyone was willing to check in on each other's progress, and I felt that we collaborated well overall.

However, when only some team members were present in the lab, decisions and updates discussed in person were not always communicated to the rest of the team. Next time, I think we could improve by sharing important decisions and progress updates in Discord, even if they were initially discussed in person. This would help everyone stay informed and avoid misunderstandings. Overall, I appreciated everyone's willingness to collaborate, and I was happy with the final product we created together.